

Ka-Kyung Kim, Ph.D.

Genomic analysis from specimen to clinical decision

Chief Researcher, Diagnosis Division, Cytogen · Seoul, Korea

Email kakyung.kim@gmail.com

Homepage kakyungkim.github.io

LinkedIn linkedin.com/in/kakyungkim

GitHub github.com/kakyungkim

Scholar scholar.google.com/citations?user=jSj0lNAAAAAJ

■ Summary

I have worked with genome, transcriptome, single-cell, and clinical multi-omics data since 2004, about seventeen years of professional work outside the doctoral period. The analysis carries through to reports and services that hospitals and the business actually use.

■ Focus Areas

- Multi-platform NGS and multi-omics analysis, including scRNA-seq
- Clinical trial data analysis (Ph1-3) and regulatory frameworks (GCLP/CAP/ISO)
- End-to-end pipeline development with automation and QC standardization
- AI/LLM-driven variant interpretation and analysis workflows (PyTorch, scikit-learn, LangChain)

■ Professional Experience

2025-present Cytogen Chief Researcher, Diagnosis Division

Develops and deploys AI for diagnostic work: a cell image review assistant, four in-house data tools on one internal portal, and shared criteria for AI tool use. Also leads CTC diagnostics, scRNA-seq pipeline development, clinical report automation, and GCLP quality systems; first to define the diagnostic service portfolio and its pricing, with the market research behind it

2021-2024 Theragen Bio Director · Clinical Analysis Team / Bioinformatics

Led Ph1-3 oncology trial analysis, obtained new GCLP accreditation and designed its data management scheme, analysis lead for the national bio-big-data pilot; oversaw a large-scale WGS delivery pipeline run on AWS to meet fast-turnaround customer demand

2018-2021 Macrogen Deputy GM · Business Development / Clinical Analysis

Led K-MASTER genomic analysis, BRCA software with CE-IVD documentation, and liquid-biopsy commercialization strategy; assessed the feasibility of licensing in an overseas genomic analysis service and set analysis-service strategy by segment (Business Development, 2021)

2015-2018 Yonsei University Postdoctoral Researcher · Biomedical Systems Informatics

Multi-omics disease variant discovery and non-coding eQTL translational research across gastric cancer PDX, canine mammary tumors, pediatric allergy, and neurological disease

2012-2015 SAIHST, Sungkyunkwan University Postdoctoral Researcher · Molecular Informatics and Genomics

Built the miRTCat database; NRF Research Fellow studying disease variants at non-canonical microRNA target sites

2007-2012 Samsung Biomedical Research Institute Researcher · Human Genomics (2007-2011 concurrent with the Ph.D.)

Korean HapMap and KARE national cohort analysis, pharmacogenomics, and genotype imputation for the Korean population

2004-2007 Korea National Institute of Health Research Technician · Center for Genome Science

Disease-associated variant discovery in the Korean population; built and operated the SNP database

■ Selected Programs

Cytogen	CTC-based liquid biopsy diagnostics Built and commercialized the end-to-end operating system for circulating-tumor-cell diagnostics: assay concept, pipeline, clinical report, and customer technical support.
Theragen Bio	Immuno-oncology clinical trial analysis, Ph1-3 Led oncology trial analysis for three pharmaceutical companies.
Theragen Bio	Large-scale WGS delivery on AWS Oversaw an AWS-based cloud pipeline for high-volume, fast-turnaround WGS delivery to pharma clients.
Macrogen	K-MASTER precision oncology genomics Led genomic analysis for a national precision-oncology platform.
Macrogen	BRCA1/2 variant analysis software, CE-IVD documentation Directed development of software spanning variant calling, clinical interpretation, and automated report generation, together with CE-IVD-grade documentation and performance evaluation.
2021-2024	Quality and regulatory systems Obtained new GCLP accreditation for a clinical specimen analysis laboratory, and established recurring certification cycles: CAP proficiency testing twice a year and ISO27001 annually.

■ Built

In-house · Vision	Cell image review assistant A confidence-based triage model for CTC image review that cut the cells needing human confirmation from 1,531 to 459 (about 70% routed to automatic handling). Trained on GPU and deployed for CPU inference in-house, with specimen-level cross-validation to block data leakage.
In-house · Tooling	AI usage criteria, four data tools, and an internal portal Compared three AI tools under the same conditions and set criteria for which task each fits, then built the tools that review, laboratory, and sales staff actually use, in consultation with each team. A test status board, a report generator, an analysis dashboard, and a literature search tool run on one internal portal, with retrieval-based question answering (RAG) that shows the answer together with its source documents.
In-house · LLM	LLM-based genomic Q&A and clinical report automation An LLM system that answers from test results and source documents (RAG), together with clinical report automation.
Personal · Validation	ADMET split audit A benchmarking study on how the train/test split changes reported performance. Compared random, scaffold, and structure-disjoint splits across 12 TDC ADMET tasks plus 3 pharmacokinetic tasks, on fingerprint+LightGBM, a message-passing neural network, and a fine-tuned ChemBERTa. Under the structure-disjoint split all 12 tasks lost performance (median drop 0.098, 5 seeds); with 15 seeds the top-10% hit rate fell in all 8 tasks evaluated, volume of distribution from 0.358 to 0.176 ($p < 0.001$). Three initial conclusions were retracted after adding seeds, and the correction was published openly.
Personal · LLM	VeriVar A somatic variant interpretation pipeline. Repository release in preparation.
Multi-agent research	AutoBioX A multi-agent research harness that splits data preparation, prediction, verification, evidence search, and manuscript drafting.

Personal · MCP

MCP servers and agents

PharmaSignal, an agent that gathers regulatory filings and clinical trial registrations to organize drug safety and competitive signals, routing inference by data sensitivity so restricted material never reaches a commercial API (Agent Forge AI Hackathon Seoul, 2026.08; github.com/kakyungkim/pharmasignal). ChillMCP, an MCP server on FastMCP with 12 model-callable tools, 5 interactive prompts, state handling, and a test client, released under MIT (SKT AI Summit Hackathon 2025 pre-task; github.com/kakyungkim/chillmcp).

AI agent · Hackathon

Vital STORM

An agent that grades key health-screening values on a five-level scale and routes to follow-up examinations, answering from four national health-screening manuals through retrieval (RAG).

Open source · Agent harness

econ-radar

An agent harness that assembles and publishes a daily economic digest weighted toward pharma, bio, and AI.

■ Selected Publications

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| 2020 | Cross-species oncogenic signatures of breast cancer in canine mammary tumors
Kim TM, ... Kim KK, ... Kim S. Nature Communications 11:3616 |
| 2019 | Whole-exome and whole-transcriptome sequencing of canine mammary gland tumors First author
Kim KK, Seung BJ, ... Kim S. Scientific Data 6(1):147 |
| 2018 | Palmitate and minimally-modified low-density lipoprotein cooperatively promote inflammatory responses in macrophages Co-first author
Ann SJ†, Kim KK†, ... Miller YI. PLoS One 13:e0193649 |
| 2013 | miRTCat: a comprehensive map of human and mouse microRNA target sites including non-canonical nucleation bulges First author
Kim KK, Ham J, Chi SW. Bioinformatics 29(15):1898-1899 |
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The full list of 20+ papers is on Google Scholar. Conference abstracts: two abstracts were accepted at GIW ISCB-Asia 2026, one oral and one poster; the poster is joint AutoBioX work, "Predictability Is Not Substitutability: A cost-of-substitution framework for H&E-based molecular prediction across 5 cancers".

■ Talks

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| 2026.11 | A reliability map for per-gene multiome RNA velocity parameters in single-cell kinetics
BIOINFO 2026 · GIW XXXV · ISCB-Asia, Seoul · oral presentation (accepted; 22 of 287 abstracts) |
| 2026.07 | The AutoBioX multi-agent pipeline
PseudoCon 2026 · talk |
| 2026.01 | Automated Clinical Reporting for Oncology NGS: Dual-Mode LLM Pipeline
ABDD Summit 2026 at Stanford · i-Talk and poster |
| 2025.11 | Single-cell QC standardization and an scRNA-seq × immunofluorescence pipeline
Future of Medicine Symposium: At the Crossroads of Computational Pathology and Spatial Biology · lightning talk |
| 2024.10 | Poster presentation, ABDD Summit
Awarded Best Poster Presentation |
| 2022.04 | Cancer: a history of the emperor of all maladies
1st K-BioX Global Mentoring EXPO · invited talk |
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■ Writing

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| 2026 | Generative AI in biotech and drug discovery: technology, cases, and ecosystem outlook BRIC View 2026-T24
A trend report separating how strong the evidence is at each stage, from protein design through the clinic. |
| 2026 | Integration and expansion of bio big data: data, AI, and industry BRIC View 2026-T11 |
| 2025 | Single-cell analysis in drug discovery and patient selection BRIC View 2025-T29 |
| 2018 | Discovery trends and outlook for allergic disease therapeutics BRIC View 2018-T16 |
| 2017 | Cloud-based management and services for genomic information BRIC View 2017-T14 |

■ Awards

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| 2025 | Cheiron ResearchThon, Creative Academic Impact Award · liquid-biopsy multi-omics model for tumor microenvironment prediction |
| 2024 | ABDD Summit, Best Poster Presentation Award · Merit Awards |
| 2021 | Medical Informatics Advanced Course, Encouragement Award · Asan Medical Center |
| 2019 | Korea Clinical Datathon, Grand Prize · sepsis prediction, KoNECT |
| 2011 | KSMCB Annual Meeting, Outstanding Poster Award |

■ Education

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| 2021-2023 | Korea National Open University B.S. Health & Environment, Business (double major) |
| 2007-2011 | Sungkyunkwan University Ph.D. Molecular Medicine |
| 2002-2004 | Korea University M.S. Life Science |
| 1996-2000 | Dongguk University B.S. Computer Science |

■ Certifications and Languages

- Engineer Information Processing (HRD Korea, 2006); Linux Master Level 2 (KAIT, 2006)
- English: OPIc IM2. Reads and writes technical documents and papers in English; one year of language study in the United States
- Machine learning and data analysis: Coursera (Johns Hopkins Univ.), KDT AIFEL Data Scientist course (2024)
- AI-driven drug discovery data analysis and SaMD model development (KOHI · KSA, 2025); Biohealth AX Executive Strategy Program (KOHI, Aug-Sep 2026)

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